
**AIRLINE CARGO REQUEST
FOR PROPOSAL (RFP) WEBSITE
HOSTING , DESIGN &
DEVELOPMENT**

ISSUED BY: AIRLINE CARGO

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1. Introduction

Airline Cargo, established in 2002 as a subsidiary of Airline Holding, has been at the forefront of transporting and handling both general and specialized cargo since its inception.

Our dedicated cargo fleet includes three A330 Freighter (A3F) aircraft, capable of medium- and long-range operations, one B737-800F. Additionally, the belly space of AIRLINE's extensive passenger fleet significantly enhances our cargo transport capabilities, with flights serving nearly 81 major international destinations across Europe, North America, Africa, the Gulf, and the Far East.

We are currently seeking proposals from qualified system integration and development firms to design and develop a modern, responsive, and user-friendly website that accurately reflects our brand identity and supports our evolving business objectives.

2. Scope of Work

2.1. Objectives

AIRLINE CARGO is currently implementing an integrated SAP ERP system alongside a Cargo Management System (CMS) known as Cargo Flash. In alignment with AIRLINE CARGO's strategic vision for digital transformation, operational efficiency, and business agility, and with the objective of expanding services through digital channels, the company aims to design and develop a modern, responsive, and user-friendly website and agent portal that reflects its brand and supports its business goals.

The new solution will provide a digital experience, ensuring a seamless, fast, and secure journey for users. Seamless integration between the newly developed web portal (www.airline-cargo.com) and Cargo Flash system will be essential to improve user experience and operational efficiency. Furthermore, AI services will be incorporated for both user interaction and data analytics.

This Request for Proposal (RFP) seeks a qualified partner to design and develop a comprehensive solution that includes the following key components:

- Establish a strong and consistent online presence aligned with the brand's identity.
- Present clear and comprehensive information about services, destinations, and capabilities.
- Enable customers to generate weight estimates, track shipments, and interact digitally with ease.
- Ensure mobile responsiveness and web accessibility compliance.
- Enable real-time Air Waybill (AWB) tracking by integrating data from the Cargo Flash system with secure, efficient data exchange.
- Facilitate future scalability and ease of system and website updates.
- Improve operational transparency and customer satisfaction by presenting detailed shipment milestones.

- Introduce advanced analytics and reporting tools to support informed decision-making.
- Conduct a detailed requirements analysis to understand AIRLINE CARGO's functional, technical, and service needs.
- Address both functional and non-functional (e.g., documentation, training, ongoing support) aspects.
- Establish a web portal for agents and frequent clients offering personalized dashboards to manage shipment history, billing summaries, and performance metrics.
- Provide training for selected staff on system maintenance and content management through the Admin Portal.

This initiative is a key step toward positioning AIRLINE CARGO as a leader in digital cargo services, both regionally and globally.

2.2. General requirements

2.2.1. Integration Features

- **AWB Tracking:** Real-time integration of AWB data to display shipment status with detailed tracking history.
- **Booking Updates:** Synchronization of booking information between the website and Cargo Flash with a user-friendly interface for editing and managing bookings.
- **Notifications:** Enable automated email or SMS updates for shipment milestones, delays, and delivery confirmations.
- **Custom Reporting:** Generate and display customer-specific reports, including shipment trends, delays, and costs.
- **Monthly Reports:** Send monthly reports that include detailed analysis of the site, visitors, the most common requests, as well as the most requested routes. In case the requested route is unavailable, it should also be included in the report.
- **Additional Online Services:** Additional Online Services (Tender – Equipment Rental)
- **Document Management:** Integration of digital copies of documents such as invoices, airway bills, and customs forms.
- **Customer Feedback:** Include a feature for customers to provide feedback on services or raise queries directly from the tracking page.
- **Payment Gateway:** Implement a secure online payment gateway to process payments through the website.
- **Top Agents Section:** Add a dedicated section or space on the website to display Airline Cargo's top 10 agents worldwide, including their contact details.
- **Dynamic Flight Schedule Display:** Show real-time cargo flight schedules, including available capacity and cutoff times for each route.
- **Cargo Invoiced Weight Estimator:** Provide a calculator for customers to input dimensions and weight to calculate invoiced weights, which is the highest between the Shipment Weight and Volumetric weight.
- **Interactive Route Map:** Display a visually appealing map showcasing Airline Cargo's network, including major hubs and destinations.
- **Dedicated Partner Portal:** Offer personalized dashboards for agents and regular clients to manage shipment history, billing summaries, and performance metrics.
- **Sustainability Tracker:** Include a feature to calculate the carbon footprint for each shipment and provide options for carbon offset programs.
- **Promotional Offers Section:** Highlight special rates, new route announcements, or seasonal offers.

- **Integrated Chat Support:** Use Chatbots to assist customers with frequently asked queries related to bookings, tracking, or documentation .in case the answers are not fully satisfactory, the conversation will be transferred to the specialist.
- **Document Center:** Provide downloadable resources like terms and conditions, packaging guidelines, and compliance documents.
- **Agent of the Month Feature:** Highlight one outstanding agent each month with their achievements and testimonials.
- **Self-Healing System:** Automated detection and resolution of technical issues without human intervention (e.g., automatic restart of failed services).

2.2.2. Website Updates:

- Add a dedicated "Shipment Tracking" section with advanced search filters (e.g., date range, shipment type, origin/destination).
- Implement a responsive design for optimal use on mobile and desktop platforms.
- Integrate a dashboard for corporate customers to manage multiple shipments simultaneously.

2.2.3. Mobile application:

In addition to the website development, Airline Cargo requires the design and development of a dedicated mobile application compatible with both iOS and Android platforms. The mobile app must include all core features and functionalities of the website, offering users a seamless and responsive experience optimized for mobile devices.

- Ensure seamless synchronization with the website for real-time updates.
- Provide offline access to selected features for greater convenience.
- Incorporate push notifications to keep users engaged and informed.

2.2.4. Data Security:

- Ensure all data exchange complies with industry-standard encryption protocols (e.g., HTTPS, SSL/TLS).
- Implement user authentication and authorization to restrict data access.
- Introduce audit logging to track access and modifications to shipment data.

2.2.5. System Testing:

- Conduct thorough integration testing, including performance, security, and user acceptance testing (UAT).
- Perform load testing to ensure the system can handle high traffic during peak times.

2.2.6. Web Server Management

- Configure, maintain, and optimize web servers (e.g., Apache, Nginx, IIS, .etc) for performance and security.
- Monitor server uptime and performance metrics, addressing any issues promptly.
- Implement server patches and updates to ensure security and stability.

2.2.7. Capabilities for Remote Support

- Offer remote support capabilities using secure remote access tools to troubleshoot and resolve issues quickly.
- Assist via email, phone, and chat to ensure prompt communication.
- Implement remote monitoring solutions to proactively identify and resolve potential issues before they impact website performance.

2.2.8. Service Level Agreement (SLA)

The vendor should provide a Support and Maintenance agreement (SLA) for 1 Year including:

- Provision of detailed Service Level Agreement (SLA).
- Pre-implementation, the Vendor should describe in detail how the SLA will monitor Service Level and Quality. Measures should include, but not be limited to, issues such as Error Correction, Error Recurrence, timely response to issues, etc.
- The SLA should cover Vendor's responsiveness to AIRLINE's request for clarifications.
- Post-implementation, the SLA should be expanded to cover system availability, Vendor responsiveness to questions, Vendor responsiveness to Error Reports, Credit Regime... etc.
- The SLA should clearly describe the vendor's responsibility of:
 - ✓ the Dev, QA servers & User Acceptance Testing Server
 - ✓ Website bug fixing
 - ✓ Management of the source code repository and versioning
 - ✓ Supporting website users/content managers (training, advanced content updates, etc.).
 - ✓ Supporting the Enterprise DXP Platform offered
 - ✓ 24/7 website uptime monitoring
 - ✓ Enhancements and Change Requests.
- A clear escalation matrix for the Vendor should be provided.
- Man/Days cost for any extra services required by Airline post phase one of the project and post implementation and user acceptance
- Ensure that the SLA includes metrics for performance evaluation and accountability.
- Regularly review and update the SLA to ensure it meets the evolving needs of the organization.

The management of the hosting environment will be the responsibility of the vendor, and a separate SLA should be provided

The general outlines required for the SLA are:

Severity	Response time	Resolve time	Coverage
Critical	1 hour	4 hours	24x7 including holidays
Medium	2 hours	1 Business Day	5X8 working days
Minor	4 hours	2 Business days	5X8 working days
Work Order/ Change request	According to the service requested and the workload evaluation (to be agreed upon)		

Severity Level Definitions:

Critical: Main website or service is down affecting negatively profit, financial transaction or any severe impact on online services and web function offered to online customers

Medium: Decreased Performance. Low financial, regulatory or customer promise Impact

Minor: Minor degradation impact to service, with no financial or regular customer promises impact

2.2.9. Performance Optimization

- Leverage API-First Design with OpenAPI or GraphQL for consistent communication.
- The vendor will define and document integration requirements, including data format, frequency, and validation rules.
- End-to-end integration testing must be conducted before deployment.
- Image Optimization: Compress and resize images without sacrificing quality to improve load times.
- Minification: Minify CSS, JavaScript, and HTML files to reduce file sizes and enhance loading speed.
- Caching Strategies: Implement browser and server-side caching to reduce load times for returning visitors

2.3. Key Features

2.3.1. Homepage:

- A welcoming and professional homepage featuring the company's brand, key messaging, and quick access to Cargo's services.
- Clear navigation options to guide users to relevant sections like Products, Services, About Us, and Contact.

2.3.2. CARGO Flight Schedule

- This is the page used to inquire about the standard flight schedule for a certain route. It is available to any person accessing the website, whether he is a public person or a registered shipping agent.

2.3.3. CARGO Flight Availability

- This is the page used to inquire about the available flight schedule for a certain route and a specific product/weight/dimension. It is available to any person accessing the website, whether he is a public person or a registered shipping agent.

2.3.4. Airline Cargo loyalty Program

Airline Cargo is proposing the launch of Airline Cargo loyalty Program, a loyalty customized program for frequent shippers and top cargo agents. The program aims to increase customer retention, boost cargo volume, enhance brand image, and reward agents.

- Target Audience: frequent shippers (corporates, exporters, importers) & top-performing agents.
- Program Structure: tiered points-based system: Bronze, Silver, Gold, and Elite (invitation-only).
- Earning Points: based on shipment weight, special cargo, priority routes, and promotions.
- Redeeming Points: freight discounts, free shipments, priority booking, special handling, storage discounts, branded merchandise, and exclusive events.
- Operations: online enrolment, automatic tracking via Cargo Flash CMS, quarterly tier upgrades, and portal-based redemption.
- Marketing: digital campaigns, personalized invitations, trade fair branding, and the slogan "Fly Higher with Airline Cargo loyalty Program."
- Benefits: stronger loyalty, increased revenues, competitive differentiation in MENA & Africa, and elevated brand prestige.

2.3.5. CARGO Map Explorer

- This is a map-interactive page used to inquire about the standard flight schedule for a certain route. It is available to any person accessing the website, whether he is a public person or a registered shipping agent.

2.3.6. Products

- EGYPTAIR Cargo customers will be able to browse this information and get answers to all the common questions related to the shipped products and any related constraints.

2.3.7. Download Center

- Downloading forms related to specific products
 - terms and conditions
 - Packaging guidelines
 - Required compliance documents

2.3.8. Complaints Submission

- This is the page accessible to the public users and registered agents to submit their complaints.

2.3.9. Agent Portal:

- A login area for registered users to track their current and previous shipments and their invoices.

2.3.10. Shipment Tracking Dashboard

- This is an advanced shipment tracking page available to the registered shipping agents to have an overview on their multiple shipments.

2.3.11. Shipping Agents – Invoices & Payment

- The system views the outstanding invoices of the agent (Invoice No., AWB No., Amount, Currency, balance)
- The system allows the agent to pay the total or partial amount of an invoice through integration with the existing payment gateway

2.3.12. Shipping Agents Maintenance

- Shipping Agent – Self Registration
- Shipping Agent – Login
- Shipping Agent – Change Password

2.3.13. Shipping Agent - Maintain Company Profile

- This is the information that the agent wants to be shown on the website to the public users who are browsing the list of agents

2.3.14. Reporting

- To enable authorized AIRLINE Cargo to generate, view, and export reports across all key website activities, including customer engagement, flight searches, and complaints.

2.3.15. Customer Support:

- A live chat feature or chatbot (Arabic and English) to assist visitors with inquiries in real-time.
- Contact forms, phone numbers, and email addresses for customer support.

Chat bot Features:

- FAQs
- Dynamic dialogue
- AI powered
- Live Chat (with Agent)
- Reporting tools& Analytics
- Supports English and Arabic languages

2.3.16. Content Management features:

A customized CMS for managing website content, including:

- Scalable architecture for future enhancements
- News and updates.
- Product details and descriptions.
- Multimedia resources like videos and images.
- Content Approval Workflows: Set up workflows for content approval to streamline the publishing process and maintain quality.
- Ability to create posts and updates for future publication, allowing for better content management.
- FAQ Section: Contains the common questions that might be asked by users or be generated.
- User Activity Logs: Track user activities within the admin interface to enhance security and accountability.
- Advanced personalization.
- Analytics for customer journey.
- Omnichannel Support like social media, IoT, kiosks
- Can be replaced by an Enterprise digital experience platform Backend system if needed with no extra implementation fees.

2.3.17. Mobile Responsiveness:

- The website should be fully optimized for mobile devices to provide a seamless user experience across smartphones and tablets.

2.3.18. Security Features:

- SSL encryption for secure data transmission.
- Secure login and data protection protocols for sensitive customer information.
- Implement SSL/TLS for data in transit and at rest for customers data.

- Access Control: The system shall provide multiple administrative levels (Role-based access control (RBAC) for users, customers, and admins.)
- Authentication: Multi-factor authentication (MFA) for agents' portal and admin access.
- Monitoring: Real-time monitoring tools for detecting anomalies.
- The system must provide password policy (Complex passwords, history, and min no of characters).
- Provide the ability to delete/disable users as needed.
- The system shall provide for the user connection to timeout if the application has not been used for a specified duration of time.
- The system shall provide permission-based reporting so that audits and reviews of security levels are provided.
- Provides a full description of the data breach policy

2.3.19. Architecture Requirements

- The system must conform to a three-tier architecture, ensuring a clear separation between the presentation, business logic, and data access layers.
- The frontend must be implemented using modern frameworks such as Angular, React, or Vue.js.
- The backend should be developed using either Java/Spring Boot or .NET Core, following microservices-based architecture.
- The database must be Microsoft SQL Server.
- The application must be fully compatible with hosting on the Microsoft Azure cloud platform, supporting scalability, security, and performance requirements.
- The proposal must define the database strategy, specifying whether each microservice will have its own dedicated database or will operate using a shared model.
- Details of inter-service communication mechanisms (e.g., REST APIs, message queues) and shared/common functionalities (e.g., authentication, logging, error handling) must be clearly outlined

2.3.20. Operational Support

- The bidder must provide operational support responsible for managing the day-to-day operations of the web application. This includes, but is not limited to:
 - Executing deployment tasks
 - Performing regular backup and restore procedures
 - Monitoring system health and performance to ensure availability and reliability
 - Maintaining deployment pipelines and handling application updates and upgrades
 - Monitoring database performance and applying necessary security patches and updates

2.4. Hosting Requirements

The vendor will offer a hosting solution and provides its high-level design with the minimum following features:

- Scalable and efficient
- High availability features (redundancy)
- Network Firewalls

- Web application Firewalls
- DDOS attacks prevention and bot mitigation.
- 2 different sites in 2 different geo locations (preferably in 2 continents) for high availability and as DR site
- Min Bandwidth 3TB per site
- Include staging environment
- Test environment will be the responsibility of the vendor
- The system is available 365 days, 24 hours per day except for scheduled outages during the year for major maintenance which the vendor should inform the carrier in advance (date/period).
- Guarantee of reliable and proper backups and copies at a safe location of data and information.
- Provides Disaster Recovery capabilities implemented and Backup policy

2.5. Strategic Requirements

- Develop a detailed project plan covering all phases, objectives, activities, training, and recommendations.
- Collaborate closely with Airline Cargo during all design and development stages to define user needs and functionalities.
- Create wireframes, prototypes, and site maps for better visualization.
- Ensure Airline Cargo's brand identity is effectively represented.

2.6. Functional Requirements

- A visually appealing, user-friendly, and responsive design adaptable to different devices.
- Easy navigation, search tools, and an FAQ section.
- Dynamic news feed, contact forms, and multilingual support (Arabic and English).
- Contact Us: Visually appealing Contact Us forms
- White Space: Careful use of whitespace to ease clutter and make it easier for visitors to read and navigate around the website.